

KALABE KEBEDE

Senior Software Engineer | Forward Deployed Engineer

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github.com/Kalab21 | Portfolio: developer-portfolio-iota-ten.vercel.app

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer and Forward Deployed Engineer with 6+ years of experience building and modernizing enterprise systems across banking, financial services, insurance, analytics, and AI-enabled applications. Strong in Java, Spring Boot, distributed systems, Apache Kafka, SQL/data engineering, AWS, APIs, and production delivery, with recent hands-on work in Python, FastAPI, RAG, AI evaluation, and brownfield modernization. Experienced from requirements and system analysis through implementation, security, observability, automated verification, release, and production support.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software & Distributed Systems: Java 8-21, Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Spring Security, Spring Data JPA, REST APIs, Microservices, Apache Kafka, Event-Driven Architecture, API Gateway, Concurrency, Idempotency

Cloud & Delivery: AWS, EC2, ECS/Fargate, S3, Lambda, RDS, CloudWatch, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Maven, CI/CD

Data Engineering & Analytics: Advanced SQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, ETL/ELT, Data Pipelines, Data Quality, Query Optimization, Indexing, Data Modeling, Power BI, Tableau

Applied AI & FDE: Python, FastAPI, RAG, LLM Integration, AI Evaluation, Human-in-the-Loop, Brownfield Analysis, Requirements Synthesis, Spec-Driven Development, ADRs

Security, Reliability & Testing: OAuth2/OIDC, JWT, RBAC, OWASP concepts, Logging, Metrics, Tracing, Reconciliation, JUnit 5, Mockito, Pytest, Playwright, Integration Testing, TDD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Revature | Forward Deployed Engineer

May 2026 - Sep 2026

Remote

- Modernized inherited multi-service lending and assessment platforms by tracing workflows across APIs, services, databases, authorization boundaries, and operational controls, then delivering verified changes without breaking existing contracts.
- Built a grounded RAG policy assistant for lending staff while keeping deterministic decisioning as the system of record; strengthened RBAC, decision finality, idempotency, auditability, reconciliation, and data-integrity controls.
- Translated business and regulatory requirements into specifications and ADRs; added automated verification, structured logging, metrics, tracing, and CI/CD gates across Python/FastAPI and Next.js services.
- Completed candidate, trainer, scoring, reporting, analytics, and role-aware workflows across PostgreSQL/MongoDB-backed services and Nginx/API-gateway routing.

Lovelytics | Data & Analytics Engineer

Dec 2024 - Nov 2025

Remote

- Designed SQL-based analytics and reporting solutions using PostgreSQL/MySQL, ETL/ELT, Power BI, and dimensional modeling; translated stakeholder needs into maintainable KPI models and dashboards.
- Built AWS analytics workflows with Athena, S3, Glue, and RDS, with validation and data-quality checks for reliable downstream reporting.
- Optimized analytical SQL with CTEs, window functions, indexing, aggregation, and caching; automated recurring transformation and reporting workflows with Power Query and DAX.

JPMorgan Chase | Java Software Engineer - Contract

May 2024 - Sep 2024

Columbus, OH | Hybrid

- Modernized enterprise banking services with Java and Spring Boot, improving API/database efficiency, maintainability, and deployment reliability in a compliance-sensitive environment.
- Built secure microservices and integrations using Spring Security, Spring Data JPA, Oracle, Redis, AWS, REST APIs, SFTP, and SMTP; supported issues across application, integration, and data layers.
- Improved reliability through query tuning, caching, automated tests, exception handling, Docker/Kubernetes practices, code review, CI/CD, and production support.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE - CONTINUED

Scale AI / Outlier AI | AI Data Specialist - Flexible Contract

Apr 2024 - Feb 2025

Remote

- Validated and refined AI-generated datasets and responses for factual accuracy, semantic quality, and alignment with task requirements and business logic.
- Performed reviewer-level quality checks and provided targeted feedback to improve consistency across peer submissions.

Investors Bank | Java Software Engineer

Apr 2021 - Dec 2023

Remote

- Modernized legacy core-banking workflows into Spring Boot microservices and Kafka-based event-driven services using PostgreSQL and Redis while preserving transaction and data integrity.
- Improved database and backend performance through SQL refactoring, indexing, caching, and asynchronous processing; supported production troubleshooting across distributed services.
- Automated build, test, and delivery workflows with Jenkins and GitHub Actions and collaborated with architects, QA, and business partners on incremental modernization.

Erie Insurance | Java Software Engineer

Mar 2019 - Feb 2021

Erie, PA | Hybrid

- Developed Java backend services and REST APIs supporting claims, policies, customers, and transaction-processing workflows.
- Implemented concurrency-safe processing, Hibernate/JPA persistence, MySQL query optimization, automated testing, and production troubleshooting for business-critical services.

SELECTED ENGINEERING PROJECTS

Northbank Banking Platform - Personal Flagship | Distributed Systems & Financial Engineering

github.com/Kalab21/banking-platform

- Java 17/Spring Boot platform with 11 business services plus gateway/Eureka, Apache Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, Next.js, Docker, transaction-safety controls, and 1,482 automated tests in CI.

Meridian Lending - Team/FDE | Applied AI

github.com/2463-FDE/KK-meridian-lending

- Brownfield lending modernization covering decisioning, manual review, disclosures, servicing, payments, reconciliation, observability, governance, and a grounded staff-only RAG policy assistant.

Rev-Eval - Team/FDE | Full-Stack Platform Engineering

github.com/RevatureFDEPEP/rev-eval/tree/kalabek

- FastAPI/Next.js assessment platform with scoring/idempotency, trainer workflows, reporting/analytics, JWT/RBAC, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MinIO, Nginx, and CI/CD.

MarketHub - Personal | Java Full-Stack Engineering

github.com/Kalab21/markethub

- Spring Boot MVC marketplace with Spring Security, JPA/MySQL, Thymeleaf, Docker, GitHub Actions, and 39 automated tests.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

B.S. Computer Science - Maharishi International University - 2023

B.S. Electrical & Computer Engineering - Haramaya University - 2015

Data Analytics Certificate - Per Scholas